

COMP 305 Full Stack Tutorial

Kai Laitinen

Setup and Install

You will need:

- Microsoft SQL Server Management Studio database
- An Express Microsoft SQL Server
- A GitHub account
- Microsoft Visual Studio
- Node.js
- Microsoft Visual Studio Code
- GitBash

All of which should be up to the latest versions, you can check to make sure they are in your installer(s). Microsoft Visual Studio should also have the ASP.NET packages installed with the initial installation.

SSMS: [Install SQL Server Management Studio | Microsoft Learn](#)

SSMS Server: [SQL Server Downloads | Microsoft](#)

MVS: [Visual Studio: IDE and Code Editor for Software Development](#)

Node.js: [Node.js — Download Node.js®](#)

VSC: [Visual Studio Code - The open source AI code editor | Your home for multi-agent development](#)

GitBash: [Git - Install for Windows](#)

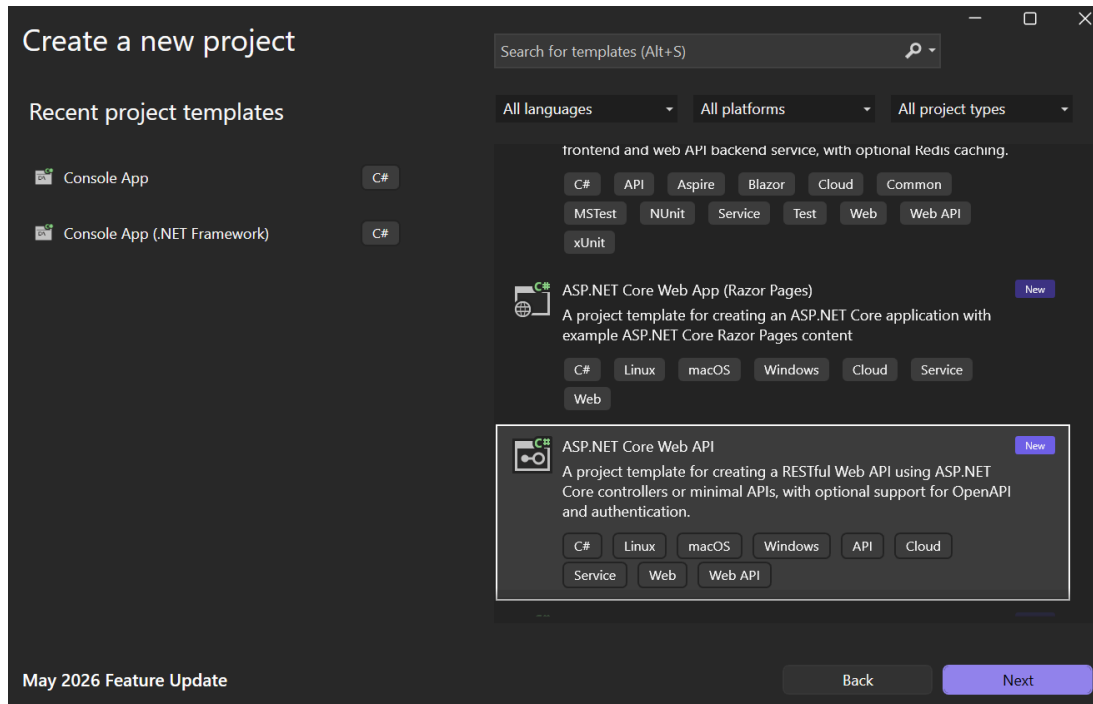
If you have trouble downloading SSMS, a server, connection with the server (check Trust Server Certificate) and creating tables, look it up or use AI. This is a tutorial for the front end and back end basics.

Starting In Microsoft Visual Studio

IF YOU DID NOT INSTALL ASP.NET with your Microsoft Visual Studio, go back to your installer and do so.

In SSMS, make sure your table(s) has a primary key with identity (1,1) for the models we will be scaffolding.

We will be using this template for your project, if you cannot see it in your templates, scroll down, search and then check if you installed ASP.NET with your MVS.



Create .NET Web API basic solution.

Back End

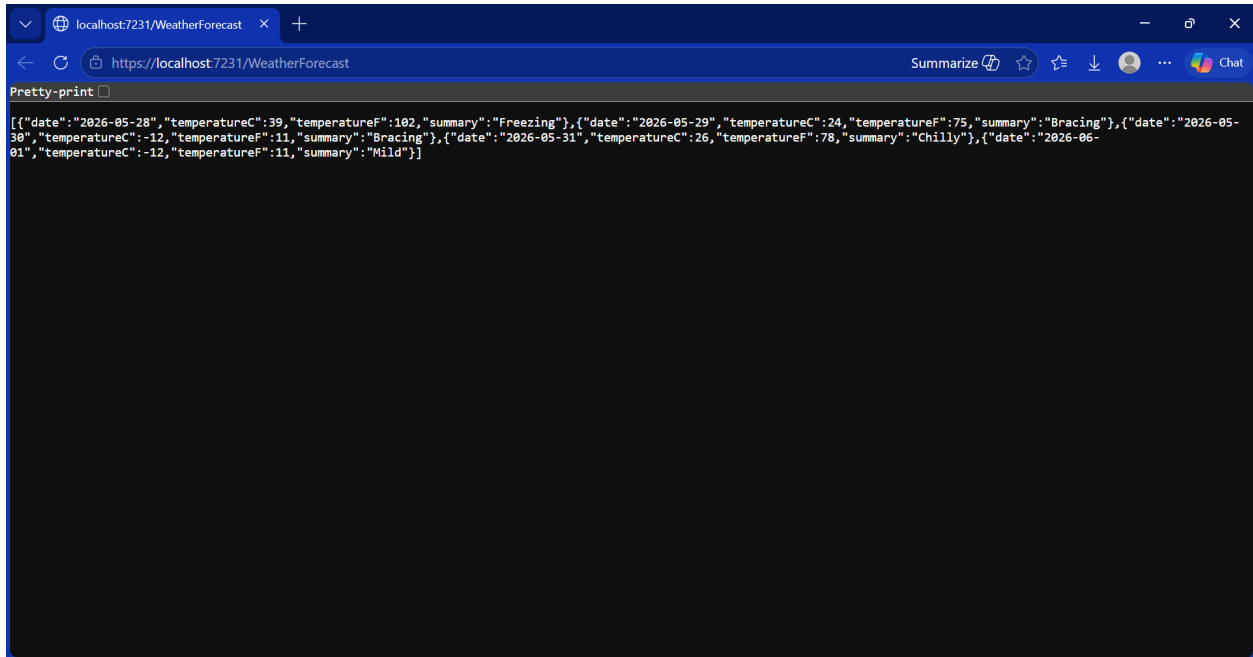
Basic back end with API endpoints in MVS

Open your Solution Explorer from View, it is vital for everything we will be doing.

Initial Test

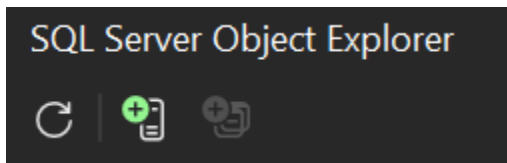
Go to Properties and open launchsettings.json.

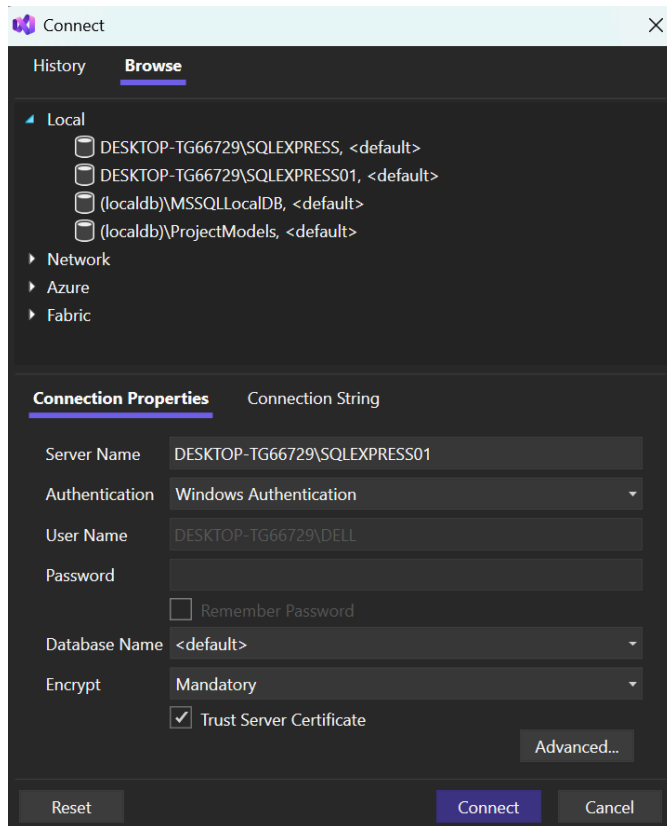
Change either the https or http profile to have *"launchBrowser": true* and add *"launchUrl": "WeatherForecast"*. If there is a problem in launching this, other than trusting localhost and Hot Reload, figure it out yourself, this is a learning opportunity. Otherwise, you should get this:



SQL Server

To connect a server, go to View=>SQL Server Object Explorer=>Add DB=>Browse=>Local=>(YOUR DB).





NuGet

Go to Project=>Manage NuGet Packages...=>Browse

Download STD Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore packages. (.SqlServer, Tools, and Design)

Install the latest versions of each.

Put this string with your connection string into the Git package terminal in Tools=>NuGet Package Manager=>Package Manager Console:

Scaffold-DbContext "ConnectionString" Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.SqlServer

Your Connection string is in the SQL Server Object Explorer inside the properties of the server instance. But, you must add *"Initial Catalog=DATABASENAME;"* inside the connection string to specify your database inside the server.

This makes your models.

Connection String Setup

In appsettings.json add

```
"ConnectionStrings": { "DefaultConnection": "YourConnectionString" }
```

Make sure this is not inside "logging" of appsettings.json

In [Program.cs](#) add (before `var app = builder.Build();`)

```
builder.Services.AddDbContext<YOUR_DB_CONTEXT_HERE>(options =>  
options.UseSqlServer(builder.Configuration.GetConnectionString("DefaultConnection")));
```

And

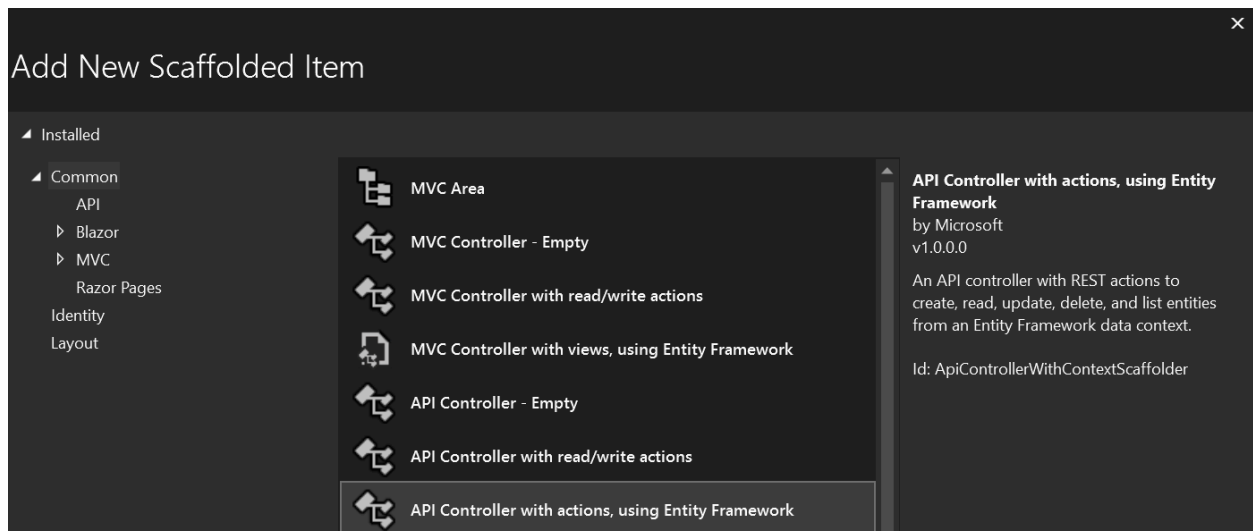
```
using Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore;  
using <Solution>;
```

At the top, if they did not already appear.

RUN THE SOLUTION TO MAKE SURE IT WAS NOT BROKEN IN THE PROCESS

Controllers

We will now make a controller, starting with Controllers=>Add=>New Scaffolded Item=>API Controller with actions, using Entity Framework



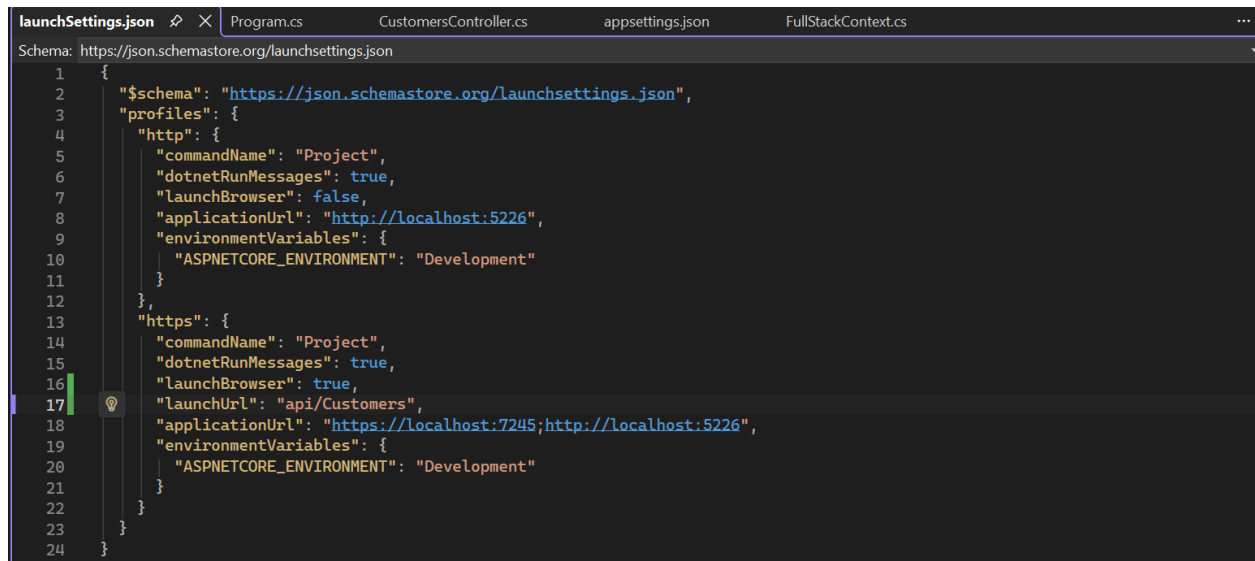
This should build out a controller for a table of your given scaffolded database.

We can now change the launchUrl to “api/Customers” (in this example) and run the solution to get this simple back end.

This should set everything up for you. Then go to launchSettings in Properties and change the launchUrl to “api/Customers”

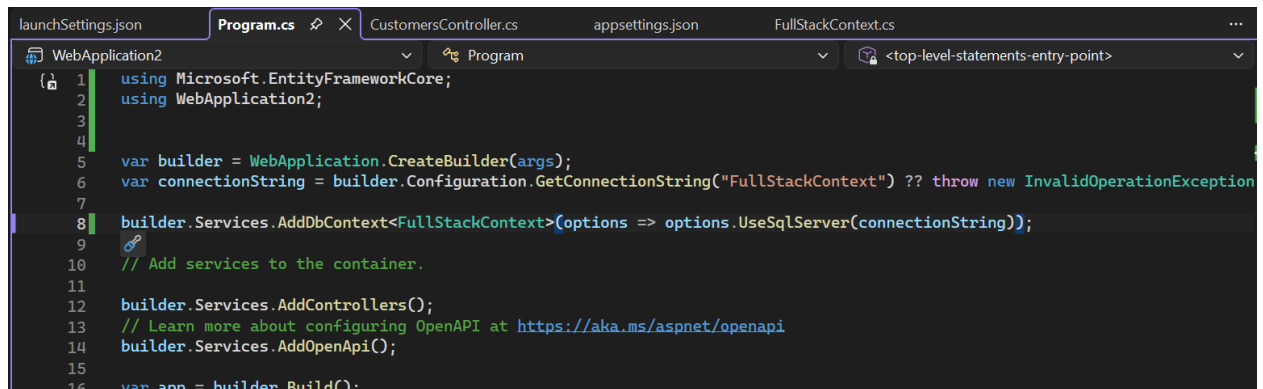
Then go into [program.cs](#) and add `using <NameOfSolution>`

Running this should make a window appear with JSON data. This is how mine looks:



The screenshot shows the `launchSettings.json` file in Visual Studio. The file is open in the editor, and the schema is `https://json.schemastore.org/launchsettings.json`. The JSON content is as follows:

```
1 {
2   "$schema": "https://json.schemastore.org/launchsettings.json",
3   "profiles": {
4     "http": {
5       "commandName": "Project",
6       "dotnetRunMessages": true,
7       "launchBrowser": false,
8       "applicationUrl": "http://localhost:5226",
9       "environmentVariables": {
10        "ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT": "Development"
11      }
12    },
13    "https": {
14      "commandName": "Project",
15      "dotnetRunMessages": true,
16      "launchBrowser": true,
17      "launchUrl": "api/Customers",
18      "applicationUrl": "https://localhost:7245;http://localhost:5226",
19      "environmentVariables": {
20        "ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT": "Development"
21      }
22    }
23  }
24 }
```

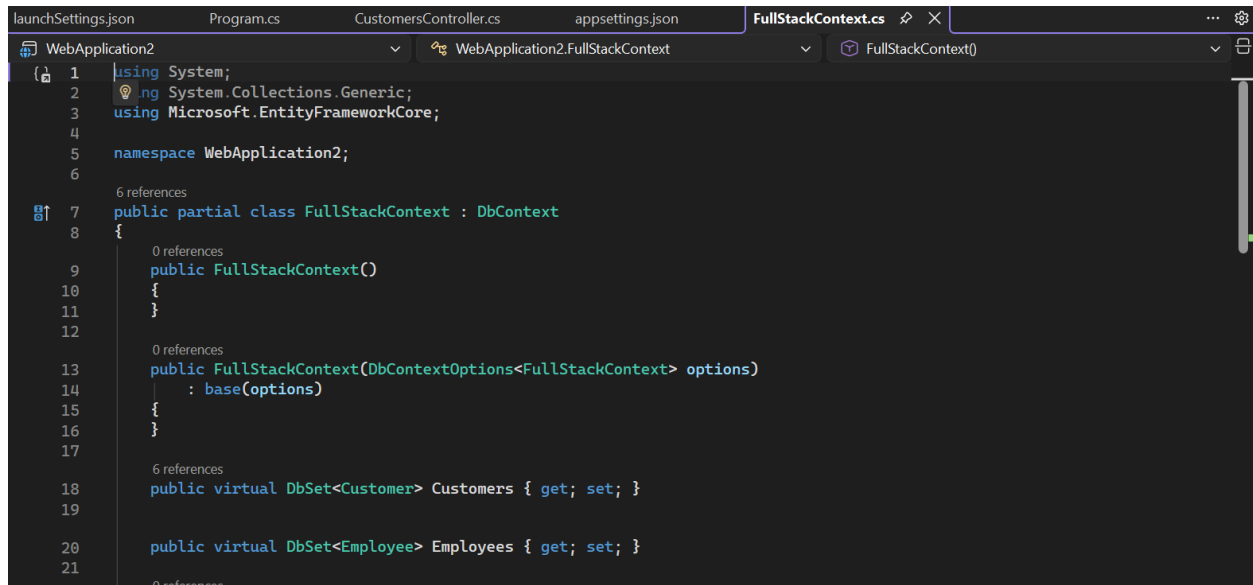


The screenshot shows the `Program.cs` file in Visual Studio. The file is open in the editor, and the schema is `<top-level-statements-entry-point>`. The C# content is as follows:

```
1 using Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore;
2 using WebApplication2;
3
4
5 var builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);
6 var connectionString = builder.Configuration.GetConnectionString("FullStackContext") ?? throw new InvalidOperationException
7
8 builder.Services.AddDbContext<FullStackContext>(options => options.UseSqlServer(connectionString));
9
10 // Add services to the container.
11
12 builder.Services.AddControllers();
13 // Learn more about configuring OpenAPI at https://aka.ms/aspnet/openapi
14 builder.Services.AddOpenApi();
15
16 var app = builder.Build();
```

```
launchSettings.json  Program.cs  CustomersController.cs  appsettings.json  FullStackContext.cs
WebApplication2
1  using Microsoft.AspNetCore.Mvc;
2  using Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore;
3  using WebApplication2;
4
5  [Route("api/[controller]")]
6  [ApiController]
7  public class CustomersController : ControllerBase
8  {
9      private readonly FullStackContext _context;
10     public CustomersController(FullStackContext context)
11     {
12         _context = context;
13     }
14
15     // GET: api/Customers
16     [HttpGet]
17     public async Task<ActionResult<IEnumerable<Customer>>> GetCustomers()
18     {
19         return await _context.Customers.ToListAsync();
20     }
21
22     // GET: api/Customers/5
23     [HttpGet("{id}")]
24     public async Task<ActionResult<Customer>> GetCustomer(long id)
25     {
26         return await _context.Customers.FindAsync(id);
27     }
28
29     // DELETE: api/Customers/5
30     [HttpDelete("{id}")]
31     public async Task<ActionResult> DeleteCustomer(long id)
32     {
33         return await _context.Customers.RemoveAsync(id);
34     }
35 }
```

```
launchSettings.json  Program.cs  CustomersController.cs  appsettings.json  FullStackContext.cs
Schema: https://www.schemastore.org/appsettings.json
1
2  'Logging': {
3    'LogLevel': {
4      'Default': 'Information',
5      'Microsoft.AspNetCore': 'Warning'
6    }
7  },
8  'AllowedHosts': '*',
9  'ConnectionStrings': {
10    'DefaultConnection': 'Data Source=DESKTOP-TG66729\\SQLEXPRESS01;Initial Catalog=FullStack;Integrated Security=True;Connect T
11    'FullStackContext': 'Server=(localdb)\\mssqllocaldb;Database=FullStackContext;Trusted_Connection=True;MultipleActiveResultSe
12  }
13
```

The image shows a screenshot of the Visual Studio Code editor. The top of the window displays several open files: launchSettings.json, Program.cs, CustomersController.cs, appsettings.json, and FullStackContext.cs. The 'FullStackContext.cs' file is currently selected and its content is visible in the editor. The code is written in C# and defines a 'FullStackContext' class that inherits from 'DbContext'. It includes two constructors: a parameterless one and one that takes 'DbContextOptions<FullStackContext> options'. Additionally, it defines two DbSet properties: 'Customers' of type 'DbSet<Customer>' and 'Employees' of type 'DbSet<Employee>'. The editor interface includes a sidebar on the left showing the project structure with 'WebApplication2' and 'FullStackContext()' under it. A vertical scrollbar is visible on the right side of the code editor.

Front End

Basic back end in Visual Studio Code using Node.js

At this point it is essential to have everything from the Setup and Install section installed, as this is where it will all work together.

First we will make sure Node is installed and in VSC, go to the terminal and

```
node -v
```

```
npm -v
```

If there is an error, that is expected and next we will put

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned
```

This gives us the ability to run commands in VSC so we can use

```
npx create-react-app my-frontend
```

This will create a react front end app with the name my-frontend (or whatever name you would like, I like app1)

Now use

```
cd my-frontend
```

```
code .
```

To Isolate VSC to just out frontend

Open src=>app.js and we will overhaul the app to make it our own

```
JS App.js X
src > JS App.js > default
1 import { useEffect, useState } from "react";
2
3 function App() {
4   const [customers, setCustomers] = useState([]);
5
6   useEffect(() => {
7     fetch("https://localhost:7245/api/Customers")
8       .then(res => res.json())
9       .then(data => setCustomers(data))
10      .catch(err => console.error(err));
11   }, []);
12
13   return (
14     <div>
15       <h1>Customers</h1>
16       <ul>
17         {customers.map(c => (
18           <li key={c.id}>{c.name} - {c.email}</li>
19         ))}
20       </ul>
21     </div>
22   );
23 }
24
25 export default App;
```

Now we return to MVCS to add a way to connect to the backend via

```
EmployeesController.cs launchSettings.json Program.cs CustomersController.cs appsettings.json FullStackContext.cs ...
WebApplication2 Program
1 using Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore;
2 using WebApplication2;
3
4
5 var builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);
6 var (local variable) WebApplicationBuilder? builder on.GetConnectionString("FullStackContext") ?? throw new InvalidOperationException
7
8 builder 'builder' is not null here. text>(options => options.UseSqlServer(connectionString));
9 Describe
10 // Add services to the container.
11
12 builder.Services.AddControllers();
13 // Learn more about configuring OpenAPI at https://aka.ms/aspnet/openapi
14 builder.Services.AddOpenApi();
15
16 builder.Services.AddCors(options =>
17 {
18   options.AddPolicy("AllowReact", policy =>
19     policy.WithOrigins("http://localhost:3000")
20       .AllowAnyHeader()
21       .AllowAnyMethod();
22   });
23
24
25 var app = builder.Build();
```

This must come before the app builder.

Then we add

```

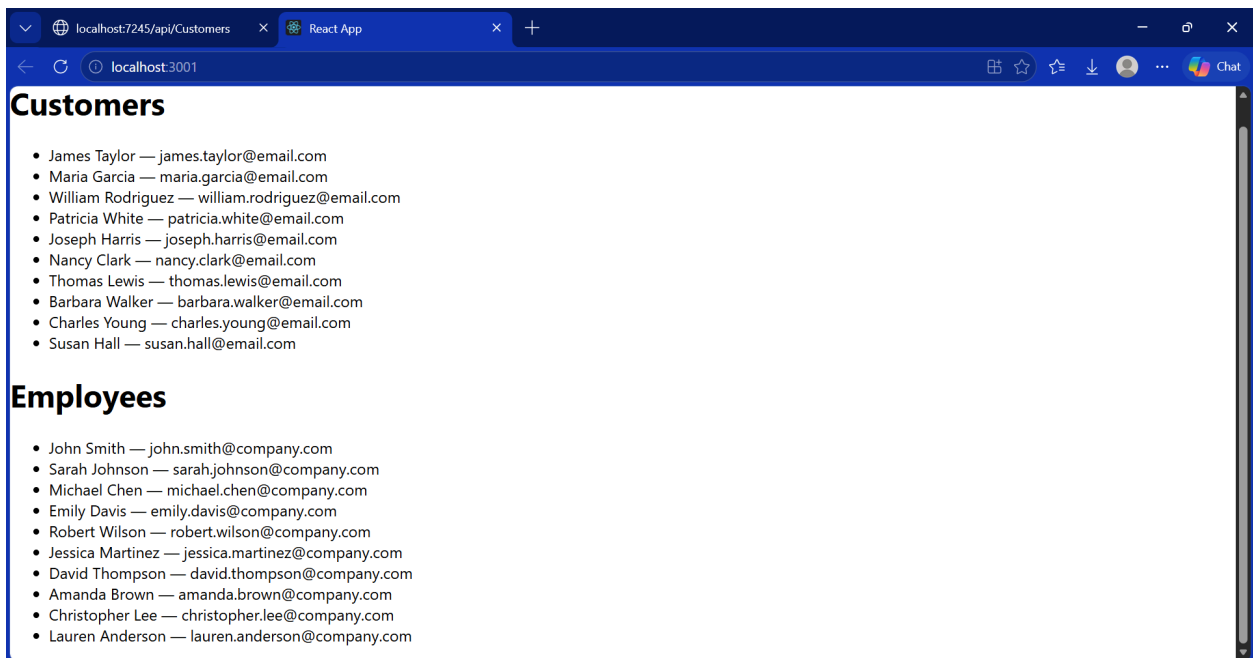
27 // Configure the HTTP request pipeline.
28 if (app.Environment.IsDevelopment())
29 {
30     app.MapOpenApi();
31 }
32
33 app.UseCors("AllowReact");
34
35 app.UseHttpsRedirection();
36
37 app.UseAuthorization();
38
39 app.MapControllers();
40
41 app.Run();

```

Before app.Run()

This creates a Cors policy to allow our specific frontend and then adds it to the backend app's functions so the frontend is allowed to access it.

We can now run the backend with the run button in MVS and use npm start in VSC to get a quaint frontend of our database:



GIT:

Using Git is very simple.

Install Git Bash.

Create a Git Repository using a free GitHub account, then copy the link for it and follow these commands in your terminal (at the correct file location ex: C:\Users\klaitinen\.vscode\app1):

```
git init
git remote add origin <paste link>
git branch -M main
git add .
git commit -m "initialize"
git push -origin main
```

And then you will have a git repository of whichever folder you were on.
Use:

```
cd ..           to go back a level
dir            to see the files in the current level
cd <file name> to navigate down
```

Or just use the open in terminal function from your file explorer to get to the proper file.

```
Mode                LastWriteTime         Length Name
----                -
-a-----          4/21/2026   1:44 PM           313 invoice.json
-a-----          4/21/2026   1:10 PM          1622 jest_sum.js
-a-----          4/21/2026   1:10 PM          977 jest_sum.test.js
-a-----          4/21/2026   1:43 PM           214 plays.json
-a-----          4/23/2026   1:41 PM          5511 statement_v0.js
-a-----          4/21/2026   1:10 PM           916 sum.js

PS C:\Users\klaitinen\Downloads\Refactoring> git init
Initialized empty Git repository in C:/Users/klaitinen/Downloads/Refactoring/.git/
PS C:\Users\klaitinen\Downloads\Refactoring> git remote add origin https://github.com/klaitinen67/RefactoringPractice.git
PS C:\Users\klaitinen\Downloads\Refactoring> git branch -M main
PS C:\Users\klaitinen\Downloads\Refactoring> git add .
warning: in the working copy of 'jest_sum.js', LF will be replaced by CRLF the next time Git touches it
warning: in the working copy of 'jest_sum.test.js', LF will be replaced by CRLF the next time Git touches it
PS C:\Users\klaitinen\Downloads\Refactoring> git commit -m "make"
[main (root-commit) 6ec5f7e] make
 6 files changed, 285 insertions(+)
 create mode 100644 invoice.json
 create mode 100644 jest_sum.js
 create mode 100644 jest_sum.test.js
 create mode 100644 plays.json
 create mode 100644 statement_v0.js
 create mode 100644 sum.js
PS C:\Users\klaitinen\Downloads\Refactoring> git push -u origin main
```

Updating the GitHub Repo is as simple as

```
git add .
git commit -m "message"
git push
```

And the current version will be added into the repository's history

